

One of my favorite people in the history of computer programming is Ada Lovelace. What I find most interesting about her is that she was able to see the potential of computers long before modern computers even existed. Ada was born in 1815, more than 200 years ago, and was the daughter of the famous poet Lord Byron. Even though women had very few opportunities in mathematics and science at the time, she became deeply interested in both.

At the time, machines like Charles Babbage's Analytical Engine were mainly viewed as tools for mathematical calculations. However, Ada realized that a machine like this could potentially do much more than just work with numbers. She imagined that if information could be represented in the right way, a machine could work with things such as symbols and even music. She also wrote detailed notes describing a method for the Analytical Engine to calculate Bernoulli numbers. Because of this, she is often described as the world's first computer programmer, even though the machine she wrote the program for was never fully built during her lifetime.

One of my favorite things about Ada Lovelace is how creative she was. She did not limit herself to what technology could already do; she thought about what it could become. She even described her way of thinking as "poetical science," combining imagination with mathematics. There is now even a day called Ada Lovelace Day that celebrates the achievements of women in science, technology, engineering, and mathematics. Her story reminds me that programming is not only about writing code or solving equations. It is also about being creative and recognizing possibilities that other people might not see yet.